Construction Site Safety: Equipment and Power Tools

Training document for the SafeSite Assistant RAG exercise

Important note: This is fictional training material prepared for software testing and learning. It is not official regulatory guidance. Verify legal requirements against the applicable jurisdiction and competent safety advice.

1. Purpose and scope

This sample describes basic checks and safe practices for common construction equipment and portable power tools. Always follow the tool manufacturer's instructions and site-specific procedures.

2. Pre-use checks

Before using a tool, inspect its body, guards, switches, cables, plugs, batteries, accessories, and safety devices. Confirm that the tool is suitable for the job and that the operator is trained and authorized.

Remove damaged equipment from service, label it so others do not use it, and report it to the designated person. Do not attempt unauthorized repairs or bypass a guard or interlock.

3. Cutting and grinding tools

Use the correct blade or disc for the material, tool speed, and task. Check that accessories are compatible and undamaged, and ensure guards are fitted and positioned correctly.

Secure the workpiece where possible. Keep hands away from moving parts, maintain a stable stance, and keep other workers outside the hazard zone. Do not force a tool beyond its design limits.

Cutting and grinding may create dust, sparks, noise, and flying fragments. Select dust controls, eye or face protection, hearing protection, and respiratory protection according to the risk assessment and applicable rules.

4. Electricity and batteries

Keep electrical equipment and connections suitable for the environment. Protect cables from crushing, sharp edges, water, and vehicle traffic. Do not use equipment with exposed conductors or damaged plugs.

Disconnect power before changing accessories or carrying out permitted maintenance. For battery tools, use compatible chargers and batteries, and stop use if a battery is swollen, leaking, overheating, or otherwise damaged.

5. Work area and shutdown

Maintain a clear work area and route cables to reduce trips and damage. Keep sparks away from flammable materials and follow hot-work controls where applicable.

Switch off and isolate equipment before leaving it unattended or clearing a jam. Wait for moving parts to stop before placing the tool down. Store equipment securely after use.

6. Questions this document can answer

What should happen if a tool's guard is missing? Remove the tool from use and report it; do not bypass the guard.

What should be checked before use? The tool, guards, switches, cables, accessories, and safety devices.

Can an untrained worker use any power tool? No. Operators should be trained and authorized for the equipment and task.

End of document.